



Gaming laptops (₹250K+)

Flagship frames, portable power

For gamers with the budget, there has never been more raw horsepower available in a laptop. At the same time, display tech and ergonomics have taken big strides. QHD+ and 4K class panels with 240 Hz refresh rates, mini LED or OLED backlights and solid colour coverage are now common in this price band. Vendors have also refined keyboards, trackpads and speaker systems for long work sessions or all night gaming marathons.

Zero1 Winner: Dell Alienware 18 Area-51

The Dell Alienware 18 Area-51 storms to the Zero1 Award by behaving more like a portable desktop than a conventional notebook. With a high-end Intel Ultra 9 275HX processor and an NVIDIA GeForce RTX 5090 mobile GPU running at a very generous TGP, it simply topped our charts in almost every gaming benchmark.

The huge 18 inch WQXGA display, with a fast refresh rate and good colour accuracy, made this machine a joy for both competitive shooters and cinematic single player titles. Alienware's cooling setup, with a complex vapour chamber and multiple high airflow fans, kept clocks high under sustained load. Overall, the Area-51 behaved like a no compromise workstation and deserved the Zero1 crown.



Dell Alienware 18 Area-51

Price: ₹4,95,390

Runner-up: Lenovo Legion Pro 7 (16IAX10H)

The Lenovo Legion Pro 7 16IAX10H with RTX 5090 came remarkably close to the Alienware in several of our tests. Its 16-inch WQXGA panel, with a high refresh rate and good HDR behaviour, proved ideal for both competitive and story driven titles, and the RTX 5090 configuration delivered excellent frame rates across our suite at native resolution. In many games at 1440p, the gap between the Legion Pro 7 and the Alienware 18 was quite small, particularly once the GPU became the main bottleneck.

In productivity and creator benchmarks, the Legion Pro 7 handled complex renders, encodes and multitasking with ease, making it a capable dual role machine for users who edit by day and game by night. It did not quite edge out the Alienware in raw numbers, yet it remains a superb gaming laptop.



Lenovo Legion Pro 7 (16IAX10H)
Price: ₹3,90,000



ASUS ROG Zephyrus G14 (2025)

Price: ₹2,74,990

Best Buy: ASUS ROG Zephyrus G14 (2025)

The ASUS ROG Zephyrus G14 (2025) GA403WR takes home the Best Buy title by proving that you do not need an oversized chassis to get serious high-end performance. In our gaming tests at the native 3K resolution, it delivered very smooth frame rates in modern titles with a sensible mix of high and ultra settings, and 1080p high refresh gaming felt effortless.

The G14's compact chassis, light weight and premium build make it much easier to live with day to day. When you factor in its price, the Zephyrus G14 GA403WR offers most compelling blend of gaming performance at incredible value.

— Mithun Mohandas | editor@digit.in